

THE DAILY FINANCE BRIEF

Financial News in Plain English

Friday, October 02, 2026

Edition No. 84

Personalised for Rishabh Srinivasan

MARKETS

U.S. Job Growth Slows, Easing Inflation Fears and Boosting Stock Markets

On October 2, 2026, U.S. stock markets saw significant gains after a report showed that job growth was much weaker than expected. The S&P 500, which tracks the stock prices of 500 large U.S. companies, increased by 0.7%, coming close to its record high. The report indicated that only 29,000 jobs were added in September, a sharp decline from the previous month. This slowdown in job growth has eased concerns about rising prices, known as

inflation, leading investors to believe that the Federal Reserve (the U.S. central bank that controls interest rates) may pause any further increases in interest rates.

The positive market response suggests that many investors are hopeful about the economy's future, as lower interest rates can make borrowing cheaper for everyone, potentially benefiting consumers and businesses alike.

Source: Associated Press

MARKETS

Nasdaq Reaches Record High as Job Growth Slows

On October 2, 2026, the Nasdaq Composite, an index that tracks the stock prices of many technology companies, hit a record high after a report showed that job growth in the U.S. was much weaker than expected. Only 29,000 jobs were added in September, which was significantly below what economists had predicted. This slowdown in job creation has led investors to believe that the Federal Reserve may delay any further increases in interest rates, which are the costs of borrowing money.

The positive market reaction indicates that many investors are optimistic about the future, as lower interest rates can encourage spending and investment, benefiting everyday consumers.

Source: London Stock Exchange

U.S. Job Growth Slows to 29,000 in September, Indicating Economic Cooling

On October 2, 2026, the U.S. Labor Department reported that only 29,000 jobs were added in September, a significant drop from the previous month's 133,000. This marks the lowest job growth in over a year and suggests that the economy may be slowing down. The unemployment rate remained steady at 4.1%, indicating that while jobs are still being created, the pace has slowed considerably.

This slowdown in job growth has led investors to believe that the Federal Reserve may hold off on raising interest rates, which could have a positive impact on consumers by keeping borrowing costs lower.

Source: *Swissinfo*

France's Interest Rates Reach Highest Level Since 2002 Amid Debt Concerns

On October 2, 2026, France's 10-year bond yield, which reflects the return investors earn from lending money to the government, surged to 4.95%, the highest level since 2002. This increase is due to growing concerns about France's rising public debt and the government's recent budget presentation, which failed to reassure investors. High interest rates can affect borrowing costs for consumers and businesses.

This situation highlights how economic conditions in one country can impact global financial markets and borrowing costs.

Source: *Le Monde*

COMPANIES

Nike Faces Challenges with Weak Demand in China and Job Cuts

On October 2, 2026, Nike's stock price fell by 10% after the company announced it expects a significant decline in annual revenue due to weak demand in China. The sports-wear giant also revealed plans for job cuts and restructuring its global business to address these challenges. Despite beating profit estimates, the company's disappointing revenue outlook led to a sharp decline in its stock price.

This situation highlights how global demand can impact major companies and, in turn, affect their employees and consumers.

Source: *London Stock Exchange*

BitGo CEO Raises Alarm Over Risks in Capital Markets Due to Regulatory Issues

On October 2, 2026, BitGo CEO Mike Belshe warned that the U.S. Senate's failure to advance the Clarity Act has left capital markets vulnerable to significant systemic risks. Systemic risks refer to the potential for a major disruption in the financial system that could affect many institutions and individuals. Belshe highlighted that firms are increasingly combining different financial functions without adequate regulations to manage these risks.

This situation underscores the importance of regulatory frameworks in ensuring the stability of financial markets, which can impact everyday consumers.

Source: *The Block*

Understanding the Clarity Act and Its Importance for Financial Markets

The Clarity Act is proposed U.S. legislation aimed at creating clear rules for firms that combine different financial functions in the digital asset space. This legislation is in the news because its failure to advance has raised concerns about the stability of capital markets. Without clear regulations, there is a risk of systemic issues that could affect many individuals and institutions.

This situation highlights the importance of regulatory frameworks in ensuring the safety and stability of financial markets, which can impact everyday consumers.

Source: *The Block*

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